BaZi Profiles

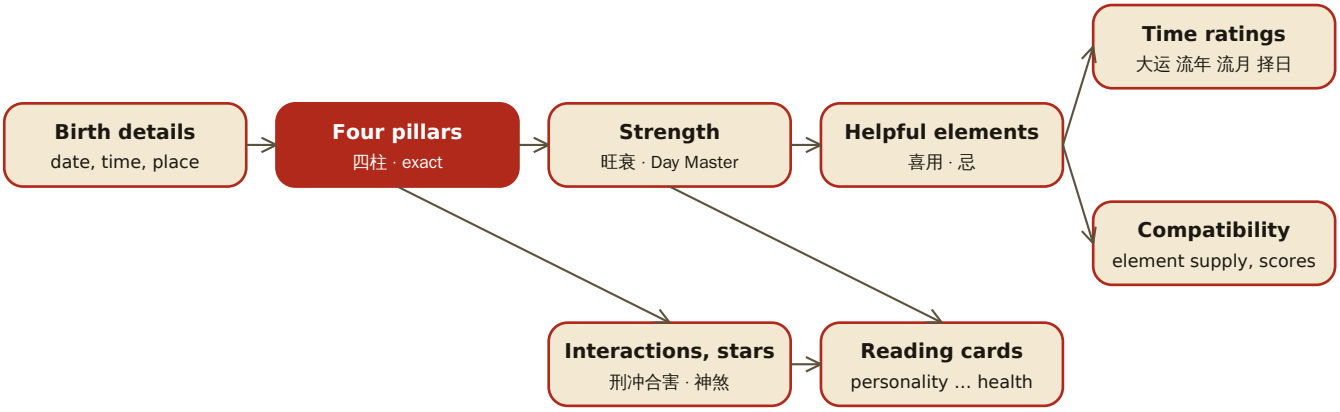
A short guide: where to start, what the words mean, how the parts fit together, and how far to trust each part. Version of 30 October 2026.

> **In one sentence.** The app calculates the four pillars exactly, then applies fixed classical rules to describe a person, their timing and how two people fit. It never guesses with AI. Every point has a **Why** button that marks the characters it comes from, says whether it is a **Classic rule** or a **Prediction** (the app's own weighting), and lets you mark whether it **fits** the person.

1. Where to start

- **Pick a language and a look.** The first screen offers Banana (English + 中文), English or 中文, in one look, the Tong Shu Almanac 通书: warm paper, black ink and a red seal. Light or dark follows your phone, or set it in Settings. A short beginner tour runs the first time you open a chart (replay it from Settings).
- **Add yourself first** (People → Add a person). Use the date and time on the birth certificate, in the ordinary Western calendar and local clock time. No lunar conversion is needed; if someone only knows their Chinese lunar birthday 农历生日, switch the form to the lunar calendar and the app converts it.
- **Check the pillars once** (Settings → Check a chart). Paste a chart you trust from a teacher or another program. If all four pillars match, the rest of the app stands on solid ground.
- **Read your Day Master**, the big character at the top of your chart. It is "you"; everything else is read against it.
- **Look at strength and helpful elements.** Nearly every rating in the app (years, months, days, compatibility) depends on them.
- **Then read the cards**: Personality, Work, Money, Love, Health and Current period. Tap **Why** whenever a line surprises you, and tap ✓ or ✗ to mark whether it fits.
- **Deep sections start folded.** Tap a section title or its › button to open it; the ☰ All sections chip jumps straight to any part. On a phone, details open in a panel that slides up from the bottom; swipe it down to close. The menu (People, This month, Compare, Ask, Settings) sits at the bottom on a phone and at the top on a tablet or computer; short notices such as "Saved" appear at the top of the screen.
- **Review a few past years** in the Year planner: tick what actually happened (job change, move, relationship…). The app compares it with what the rules expected; this is how you learn which rules suit you.

2. How the parts link



The pillars are the only exact part. Strength is worked out from them; the helpful elements follow from strength; and those helpful elements drive every supportive / mixed / challenging rating and the element side of compatibility. If you change a school rule in Settings, everything downstream updates.

3. The chart

Each person has four **pillars** 四柱 (year, month, day, hour). Each pillar is a pair: a **heavenly stem** 天干 on top and an **earthly branch** 地支 below, so eight characters 八字 in all. BaZi years begin at Start of Spring 立春 (around 4 February) and months begin at the solar terms 节气 (around the 4th to 8th), not on the 1st.

Pillar	Stands for	Notes
Year 年柱	Family background, social circle, early life	Its branch is the year animal.
Month 月柱	Career, parents, working style	The season you were born in; the strongest single influence on strength.
Day 日柱	You (stem) and your partner (branch)	The day stem is the Day Master 日主. The day branch is the spouse palace 夫妻宫.
Hour 时柱	Children, own projects, later life	Missing when the birth time is unknown; see "Find the birth hour".

Five elements and yin-yang

Wood 木, Fire 火, Earth 土, Metal 金 and Water 水. Each feeds the next (木生火生土生金生水生木) and controls the one after that (木克土, 土克水, 水克火, 火克金, 金克木). Every element comes in a Yang (outgoing) and a Yin (inward) form. The tappable five-element cycle in each chart shows these arrows and how many of each element the chart holds.

Ten gods 十神

The ten gods name how any character relates to the Day Master. The app uses short plain-English names beside the Chinese:

Group	App name · Chinese	Relation to you	In plain words
Peers 比劫	Friend 比肩 · Rival 劫财	Same element	Friends, siblings, confidence, competition
Output 食伤	Talent 食神 · Rebel 伤官	What you produce	Skills, expression, ideas; for a woman, children
Wealth 财	Steady 正财 · Windfall 偏财	What you control	Money, results; for a man, a partner

Group	App name · Chinese	Relation to you	In plain words
Officer 官杀	Authority 正官 · Pressure 七杀	What controls you	Rules, bosses, status; for a woman, a partner
Resource 印	Support 正印 · Odd Support 偏印	What feeds you	Learning, mentors, home, rest

Hidden stems 藏干 and life stages 十二长生

Each branch hides one to three stems (main, middle, residual); they count towards strength and the ten gods. The life stages show how your Day Master fares in each branch, from Birth 长生 through Peak 帝旺 to Storage 墓 and back. A branch holding your own element is a **root** 通根.

4. Strength and helpful elements

Strength 旺衰 asks whether the Day Master has enough support. The app checks three classic signs:

- **Season** 得令: does the month branch support your element?
- **Roots** 得地: do the branches hold your element?
- **Help from stems** 得势: are the other stems your element or ones that feed it?

From these it gives Strong 身强, Weak 身弱, or Balanced leaning one way 中和. A **strong** Day Master is helped by elements that use its energy (Output, Wealth, Officer); a **weak** one by elements that add to it (Resource, Peers). Very hot or very cold birth months also add a cooling or warming element (调候). Rare extreme charts are flagged as **follow** 从格 or **dominant** 专旺格, where the helpful elements reverse; treat those as candidates to confirm with a teacher.

Finer points the app now applies

- **Month in command** 人元司令: the month branch is weighted by the hidden stem in charge on your birth day, counted from the solar term.
- **Transformations** 合化 and **full frames** 三合 / 三会: a year–month stem pair that combines in its own season, or three branches that form a full frame, count as their new element.
- **Bridge** 通关: when your own element and an opposing element are both heavy and locked in a fight, the element between them becomes the first helpful element.
- **Problem and cure** 病药: when one unhelpful element is far too strong, the element that controls it moves to the front.

Chart pattern 格局

The month branch also sets a pattern, read the 子平 way: the hidden stem that shows on another stem decides it, otherwise the main stem. There are ten: Direct Officer 正官格, Seven Killings 七杀格, Direct and Indirect Wealth 正财格 / 偏财格, Eating God 食神格, Hurting Officer 伤官格, Direct and Indirect Resource 正印格 / 偏印格, Self-made 建禄格 and Blade 羊刃格 (月劫格 for a yin Day Master). Each is marked **well formed** 成格 when something supports it, **broken** 破格 when something spoils it (for example 伤官见官, 枭神夺食, 财破印), or plain. The pattern leads the Work card and adds a line to Personality.

Reading reliability 可靠性

Under each name a High / Medium / Low label says how clear-cut the chart is, with the reasons: an unknown or estimated birth hour, a birth within minutes of an hour change or within a day of a solar term, strong and weak being close, a rare chart type, or a broken pattern. It rates the chart, not the person.

5. Interactions and special stars

Interaction	Meaning in the app
Combination 六合**, half** 半合**, full** 三合**, seasonal** 三会	Things pulling together: support, attraction, teamwork. Can also tie you down.
Arching 拱合**, hidden** 暗合	Quieter bonds: two ends reaching for a missing middle, or main hidden stems that combine.
Clash 六冲	Push and pull: change, movement, disagreements. The strongest tension.
Harm 六害**, punishment** 刑**, self-punishment** 自刑**, destruction** 六破	Hidden friction, testing pressure, being hard on yourself, or small breakages. Whether 寅巳申 and 丑戌未 punish in pairs or only all three together is a school setting.
Stem combination 天干五合 **· stem clash** 天干相冲	Open attraction and cooperation, or open disagreement.

Special stars 神煞 are classic markers looked up from fixed tables: Nobleman 天乙贵人 (helpful people), Academic 文昌, Peach Blossom 桃花 (charm, romance), Travelling Horse 驿马 (movement), Canopy 华盖 (solitude, art), Goat Blade 羊刃 (drive, risk) and Void 空亡. Schools differ on how much weight to give them. **Personal directions** 八宅 come from a separate system (Eight Mansions) using only birth year and gender.

6. The reading cards

- **Personality** 性格: the Day Master picture, its strength, and the two strongest ten gods.
- **Work** 事业: the month pillar (career palace), Officer, Output and Resource patterns.
- **Money** 财运: how much Wealth there is and whether the Day Master can hold it.
- **Love** 感情: the spouse palace, the partner star (Wealth for a man, Officer for a woman), and anything clashing or combining with the day branch.
- **Health and wellbeing** 健康与心态: classical links between elements and body systems and moods. **It is for reflection and self-care only, not a medical or mental-health assessment.**
- **Current period** 当前运势: this decade and this year against the natal chart.

Ask 问一问

The Ask tab, between Compare and Settings, works like a chat: pick a person, tap Ask a question and choose one of the fixed questions: a review of this year or this month with do's and don'ts, strengths and blind spots, the environment you thrive in, career path, employment or business, wealth, money habits, the partner who suits you, relationship patterns, your current 10-year luck, this year's opportunities and challenges, recurring challenges and what to prioritise now. Each answer appears as a reply, is put together from the same rules as the rest of the chart, never written by AI, and links to the full section of that person's chart. Under each answer, **Ask next** offers two or three related questions to tap. **How do we get along this year?** (under Love) asks you to pick a second person, then gives your love and work match, what draws you together, what takes work, how this year touches you both, and the best years ahead; it links to Compare. If the birth time is unknown, the answer first says how much it depends on the hour: the app reads the chart at all 12 possible birth hours and counts how often the helpful elements (and, where it matters, the chart pattern) stay the same.

Does it fit? ✓ / ✗

Every point in Personality, Work, Money, Love and Health can be marked ✓ fits or ✗ does not fit. The marks are saved with the person. Once a rule has five or more marks across everyone you have added, it shows **Fits your people** (70% or more) or **Often off for your people** (under 40%); rules that are often off are dimmed and moved to the end of their card. The "How well the readings fit" card on This month shows the fit rate per area.

7. Timing

View	What it shows	How sure
10-year luck 大运	Decades from a start age set at birth; rated by their elements. Tap one for its first and second half, your energy level, how it meets your birth chart, do's and don'ts and the next decade.	Fairly reliable (standard method)
Year planner 流年	Any year as concrete expectations in seven life areas, each Likely, Possible or Quiet, with the reasons, how strong each is and the months it is most likely to show. Likely needs a strong signal (a clash or combination hitting a palace); ten gods alone are weak. Each area is Likely in only about one year in seven. For past years, tick what happened to test the rules.	Signals standard; Likely/Possible is my weighting
Month by month 流月	The 12 solar months of a year with real start dates and flags.	Lighter than years; colours the year
Partner and children 婚姻与子女	Decades and years when the partner star and spouse palace, or the children star and children palace, are activated. Only likely and strong years are listed.	Signals standard; levels my weighting
Good days 择日	A calendar marking days that clash you or the month (avoid) and helpful days.	Least certain; use mainly to avoid clash days

Reading a year in the planner

- **With your decade**: one line says how the year sits inside its 10-year luck, for example a harder year inside a good decade.
- **Welcome change** or **costly change**: a clash that knocks out an element working against you tends to help (冲去忌神); one that knocks out a helpful element costs you (冲去用神).
- 岁运天克地冲: the year fully clashes your 10-year luck, a major turning point, marked with !
- **Full frame**: the year, your decade and your chart complete a 三合 / 三会 together.
- After at least eight reviewed years across all your people, the planner tunes each signal to how often it actually matched.

Ratings: **supportive** 顺 means the period brings your helpful elements, **challenging** 逆 means it brings the ones to go easy on, **mixed** 平 is in between. A challenging year is not a bad year; it is one that asks more of you.

8. Compatibility

Pick two people in Compare, then choose how they are related: **Spouse** 夫妻, **Family** 家人 (with an optional parent and child), **Colleague** 同事 or **Boss** 上下级 (with who is the boss). Each relationship looks at different signals: Spouse at the day pillar and partner stars; Family at the year pillar (family palace), how the Day Masters feed each other and the child star; Colleague at the month pillar and working styles; Boss at who naturally leads, using the ten gods between the two Day Masters. The choice is remembered for that pair on your device.

Each score starts at **50** and moves with every reason listed beneath it; the number is simply 50 plus the points shown. The main Spouse and Colleague signals:

Signal	Love	Work
Spouse palaces (day branches) combine or clash	±14 (the main love signal)	small
Career pillars (month branches) combine or clash	small	±12 (the main work signal)
Day Masters combine (甲己, 乙庚 …) or clash	+12 / −8	+4 / −5
Each is the other's classic partner star	up to +8 each	—
Day Master feeds / matches / presses	small	small
Each chart supplies the other's helpful elements	up to ±6 each	up to ±5 each
Other branch interactions, weighted by pillar	capped at ±15	capped at ±15
Both in supportive 10-year luck now	±3	±3

Grades: 80+ very good 上, 65–79 good 中上, 50–64 workable 中, 35–49 needs effort 中下, below 35 challenging 下. Most pairs land between 43 and 60, so a high score stands out. "Good years together" checks the palace that carries the bond (day branch for partners, year branch for family, month branch for work) for both people: ★ good for both, ♥ a year that warms the bond, ! a testing year; "One vs all" ranks everyone against one person.

> **The limits.** Which branches combine or clash is standard. The point values, caps and grade bands are my own weighting and the least certain part of the app. Read the reasons, not just the number, and never use a score to decide about a real relationship on its own.

9. How far to trust each part

Part	Confidence	Basis
Pillars, hidden stems, ten gods, luck start	High	Calculated; tested against two libraries and independent formulas
Interaction and star tables, life stages, directions	High	Standard classical tables
Strength verdict and helpful elements	Moderate	Standard signs; my thresholds
Card wording, health links, year and month flags	Moderate	Classical associations in my own words
Chart pattern and reliability label	Moderate	Standard 子平 rules; my scoring for reliability
Partner and children timing	Low to moderate	Standard stars and palaces; my levels
Compatibility points and grades; day choice	Low to moderate	My weighting

Each point is labelled ✓ **Classic rule** for mainstream classical rules or ⚖ **Prediction** where the signals are standard but the app's own weights and cut-offs turn them into a call. **Settings → School rules** lets you match points where schools differ: the Snake 巳 hidden-stem order, how the luck start age is rounded, which branch special stars count from, where a balanced chart tips

into strong, whether climate 调候 or strength 扶抑 decides the helpful elements first, and whether to use month in command 人元司令 and transformations 合化.

10. Your data

- Only nicknames, birth details, notes, year notes, the events you tick and your ✓ / ✗ marks are stored. Charts are recalculated every time. Your language, light or dark choice and which sections are open stay on each device.
- Profiles live in your browser. With GitHub sync on, they are also kept in one file in your **private** data repo; the token stays on each device.
- **Settings → Backup** exports a dated file and imports one with Merge or Replace. **Delete all data** removes everything on this device, or everywhere.
- On the GitHub copy you can install the app on your phone; it works offline and syncs when you are back online.

Pillars are calculated with lunar-javascript (MIT licence). Readings and wording are original to this app. BaZi is a traditional system for reflection; it is not a prediction or professional advice.